

SkillSwap

Activity Blog & Meeting Log

CP476B Internet Computing · Spring 2026

Team Members	Repository
Samir Bani · Isha Shah · Shubh Upadhyay · Aryan Tagi · Laiba	github.com/Samirbani33/skillswapcp476
Wiki / Activity Blog	Course
docs/WIKI.md	CP476B Internet Computing · Spring 2026

About This Document

This Activity Blog documents all team meetings, decisions, task assignments, and technical progress throughout the SkillSwap project lifecycle. It serves as the official record for Milestone submissions and reflects the team's collaborative workflow on the CP476B course.

Quick Links

GitHub Repo: <https://github.com/Samirbani33/skillswapcp476>

Wiki / Activity Blog: <https://github.com/Samirbani33/skillswapcp476/blob/main/docs/WIKI.md>

MEETING #1 — PROJECT KICKOFF & PLANNING

Date: Week 1 — Spring 2026	Attendees: Samir Bani, Isha Shah, Shubh Upadhyay, Aryan Tagi, Laiba	Duration: 75 minutes
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Agenda & Minutes

- Brainstormed project ideas; voted on SkillSwap marketplace concept (unanimous)
- Defined problem statement: students lack a trusted peer-to-peer skills exchange
- Identified target users: university students as both buyers and sellers
- Discussed technical stack options (Node.js vs PHP) — chose PHP for simpler local setup

Decisions Made

Decision	Rationale
PHP backend over Node.js	Simpler local dev, no npm complexity, course-covered
MySQL with normalized schema	Course requirement, referential integrity, FK constraints
Session-based auth (not JWT)	Simpler to implement, course-covered approach
Separate categories table	Normalization — avoids string duplication in services
conversations + messages split	3NF — conversation is distinct entity from individual messages

Task Assignments

Task	Assignee	Due
GitHub repo + Kanban setup	Samir	Week 1
Database schema v1	All (collaborative)	Week 1
User stories + wireframes	All	Week 1
Auth module (register/login)	Isha	Week 2
Marketplace frontend	Shubh	Week 2
Booking system backend	Aryan	Week 3
Reviews system	Laiba	Week 3

MEETING #2 — MILESTONE 01 REVIEW & SPRINT PLANNING

Date: Week 2 — Spring 2026	Attendees: Full team	Duration: 60 minutes
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Progress Since Last Meeting

- GitHub repo created: skillswapcp476
- Kanban board initialized with all 5 columns and 10 user story cards
- Milestone 01 report submitted (ERD, wireframes, user stories, team plan)
- Database schema drafted — 6 tables complete

Milestone 02 Sprint Goals

1. Complete all frontend screens matching wireframes
2. Finalize and normalize database schema
3. Implement backend routes (auth, services, bookings, reviews)

4. Connect frontend to backend via fetch API
5. Run setup script and test locally

Architecture Decisions

Decision	Rationale
Single index.php front controller	Parses URI segments and delegates to route files
CORS: Access-Control-Allow-Origin: *	Required for local dev when JS calls PHP from localhost
password_hash() with PASSWORD_BCRYPT	Never store plaintext — bcrypt is industry standard
All queries use \$db->prepare() + bind_param()	Zero string interpolation — prevents SQL injection
services.category_id FK → categories	Avoids VARCHAR redundancy — properly normalized

Challenges & Resolutions

Challenge	Resolution
CORS errors when JS called PHP from file://	Added full CORS headers to index.php; use http://localhost:8000
PHP sessions not persisting across fetch calls	Added credentials: 'include' on all apiFetch calls
category as VARCHAR caused duplication	Refactored to category_id FK → normalized categories table

MEETING #3 — INTEGRATION & TESTING

Date: Week 3 — Spring 2026

Attendees: Full team

Duration: 60 minutes

Work Completed This Week

- POST /auth/register — validates, hashes password, creates session
- POST /auth/login — verifies bcrypt hash, starts session
- GET/POST/PUT/DELETE /services — full CRUD with category FK join
- GET/POST/PUT /bookings — request, accept/reject, complete
- POST /reviews — gated to completed bookings only
- GET/POST /messages — conversation threading
- GET /admin/stats|reports|users — admin moderation panel
- Frontend: Landing, Register, Login, Marketplace, Service Detail, Provider Dashboard, Customer Dashboard, Admin Dashboard, Messages
- Seed data loaded — 5 users, 6 services, 5 bookings, 2 reviews, 3 messages
- Navigation updated: logged-in state shows dashboard link + logout

Open Items for Milestone 03

- Full integration testing (end-to-end booking flow)
- Input sanitization review
- Demo video recording
- README final update

Definition of Done

1. Peer code review completed (at least one other team member)
2. Manually tested locally against the running backend
3. Kanban card moved to Done column
4. This wiki updated with the completed task and any decisions made